Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Wednesday, 14 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Overcast	Overcast	Overcast	Drizzle
19° 11°	17° 10°	17° 9°	17° 10°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The head of MI5 has warned that threats to the UK from countries like Russia and Iran are now as serious as terrorism.**

Sir Ken McCallum said that operations to counter state threats are now roughly on an equal scale to those tackling terrorism. He also highlighted the growing danger posed by artificial intelligence.

NATIONAL SECURITY · UK

2 **Argentina has launched a new legal challenge against the UK over oil exploration near the Falkland Islands.**

The action has been filed with an international maritime tribunal, marking the latest development in an escalating dispute over the islands. This follows previous tensions between the two nations.

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS · UK

3 **A man who died after entering a tiger enclosure at Yorkshire Wildlife Park has been identified as William Chapman.**

Mr Chapman, who was in his twenties, tragically died after the incident at the popular visitor attraction. Police are continuing their investigation into the circumstances.

TRAGEDY · UK

4 **Hundreds more prisoners are being released early in the second phase of a government scheme designed to ease overcrowding.**

This tranche includes inmates serving sentences of up to two and a half years. The controversial policy aims to free up space in the UK's prisons.

JUSTICE · UK

5 **Almost 5,000 people were evacuated in the City of London yesterday due to a major gas leak.**

A large cordon was put in place between Threadneedle Street and London Wall, causing significant disruption. Thankfully, the area has now been cleared and people are being allowed back into their properties.

EMERGENCY · UK

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02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Award-winning singer Raye has hit back at ticket touts after an incredible 1.8 million people signed up for her 5,000-seat Royal Albert Hall show.**

The huge demand for tickets for her upcoming performance clearly shows her soaring popularity. Raye expressed frustration at touts overwhelming the sign-up process.

ON AIR — Have you ever been caught out by ticket touts, or managed to get a great deal on a last-minute ticket?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **Fans of Gavin and Stacey will be thrilled to hear that stars of the show are featuring in a new festive TV adaptation.**

Rob Brydon will be voicing a character in an adaptation of a Julia Donaldson picture book, set to air over Christmas. It's bound to be a family favourite.

ON AIR — What's your favourite Julia Donaldson book, and which one would you love to see adapted for TV?

TV · CHRISTMAS

3 **The boss of Fortnite-maker Epic Games has confirmed a 'huge pivot' towards using Artificial Intelligence in their future projects.**

The US firm's chief responded to critics, stating that while some wish it were still 2016, the industry has moved on. This signals a big shift for one of the world's biggest gaming companies.

ON AIR — Are you excited or nervous about AI playing a bigger role in the games you play?

GAMING · FUTURE

4 **Screams, haunting scenes, and deadly hide-and-seek were all part of the drama as Celebrity Traitors heated up on Friday night.**

Episode four saw two more contestants depart, a ghoulish mission near a graveyard, and a spooky twist. The show is really gripping viewers as it heads towards its climax.

ON AIR — Who do you think is playing the best game on Celebrity Traitors, and who's your pick to win?

TV · THIS WEEK

5 **Taylor Swift dominated the recent VMAs, sparking a debate about whether music videos still hold the same importance today.**

A cinematographer noted that the purpose of music videos has evolved with the growth of platforms like TikTok. They're still a creative outlet, but their role in promotion has changed.

ON AIR — Do you still watch music videos, or do you mostly catch clips on social media now?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **The head of English football's new independent regulator has stated he would resign if there's any political interference in the Manchester City case.**

This strong stance comes after Manchester City were found guilty of breaching Premier League financial rules. The regulator emphasised his commitment to an unbiased process.

ON AIR — Do you think an independent regulator will be good for the integrity of English football?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **A new report warns that the majority of English football clubs are on the brink of 'financial disaster'.**

The regulator's report highlights that English football's finances are 'dangerously exposed'. Many clubs are said to be living on the edge, raising concerns for the sport's future.

ON AIR — What do you think needs to change to make English football clubs more financially stable?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Coventry City pulled off a stunning 4-1 victory over Newcastle United to claim their first home win of the season.**

It was an emphatic performance from Coventry, securing their first Premier League home win in 25 years. The result has certainly given their fans something to cheer about.

ON AIR — What's the most surprising football result you've seen this season, and why?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Flat racing's 'Billy the Kid', Billy Loughnane, is set to be crowned champion jockey on Saturday and is aiming for a new record.**

The prodigy, nicknamed 'Billy the Kid', has had an incredible season. He's not just content with the title, but also has his sights set on making history.

ON AIR — Do you follow horse racing, and have you been impressed by any young talents this season?

RACING · UK

5 **Rory McIlroy has indicated he would vote to allow LIV Golf players to return to the PGA Tour.**

The Northern Irish golfer believes the breakaway circuit no longer poses a threat to traditional tours. This could signal a thawing of relations in the world of golf.

ON AIR — Do you think LIV Golf players should be allowed back on the PGA Tour, or should they stick with their new circuit?

GOLF · THIS WEEK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1. **British gardeners are finding joy in cultivating 'micro-meadows' in small urban spaces.**
   These miniature patches of wildflowers and grasses are creating delightful havens for bees and butterflies, proving you don't need a huge garden to make a big impact on local wildlife.

2. **The simple pleasure of 'leaf peeping' is gaining popularity, as people actively seek out vibrant autumnal displays.**
   Forget exotic holidays; many are now planning day trips or weekend breaks purely to admire the stunning reds, oranges, and golds of the British countryside.

3. **A new trend sees people sharing their 'unusual mug collections' on social media, showcasing quirky and sentimental designs.**
   From vintage finds to gifts with funny messages, these much-loved mugs often tell a story, making that morning cuppa even more special.

4. **The calming art of 'slow living' is inspiring more of us to embrace traditional crafts like knitting and pottery.**
   It's all about disconnecting from digital demands and finding mindful satisfaction in creating something tangible with your own hands.

5. **Home bakers are experimenting with 'foraged ingredients' to add unique flavours to their cakes and bakes.**
   Think elderflower in sponges or blackberries in crumbles, adding a delicious, seasonal twist to classic recipes.

6. **The satisfying ritual of 'watering houseplants' is becoming a small moment of daily mindfulness for many.**
   It's a gentle reminder to slow down, connect with nature, and observe the quiet growth of your indoor greenery.

7. **More people are discovering the joy of 'writing a proper, physical shopping list' with a pen and paper.**
   There's something wonderfully satisfying about ticking off items as you go, and it often leads to fewer impulse buys too!

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new bar of soap, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: SMELLING IT AT LEAST THREE TIMES, OFTEN WITH A LITTLE HUM OF APPROVAL!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of bread will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?**

ANSWER: GIVING IT A GENTLE, ALMOST IMPERCEPTIBLE SQUEEZE TO CHECK FOR FRESHNESS AND SPRINGINESS!

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those little 'comfort items' that just make life better, don't we?**
  Perhaps it's a particular blanket, a favourite old jumper, or even a specific brand of tea that just hits the spot. What's your go-to comfort item, and why is it so special?

- **There's something wonderfully satisfying about 'getting a really good bargain'.**
  Whether it's finding a hidden gem in a charity shop, snagging a great deal in the sales, or even just getting an unexpected discount, what's the best bargain you've ever found?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A group of owls is called a 'parliament', but a gathering of badgers is known as a 'squabble'.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896; it lasted only 38 minutes.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest, as they have been observed at altitudes of up to 9,000 metres.
- The original name for the butterfly was 'flutterby'.
- A 'bibliosmia' is the enjoyable smell of old books.
- The first orange cultivated in Europe was bitter and used mainly for medicinal purposes, not for eating.
- Mars is known as the 'Red Planet' because of the iron oxide prevalent on its surface, which is the same compound that gives blood and rust their colour.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in their lifetime.
- The world's largest grand piano, weighing over a tonne and standing three metres high, was built by a New Zealander.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES WED 14 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 287 of the year, 78 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Angadrisma; Christian feast day: Fortunatus of Todi; Christian feast day: Joseph Schereschewsky (Episcopal Church (USA)); Christian feast day: Pope Callixtus I. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1940 — Cliff Richard, Indian-English singer-songwriter and actor
- 1990 — Jordan Clark, English cricketer
- 1963 — Lori Petty, American actress
- 1960 — Steve Cram, English runner and coach
- 1930 — Robert Parker, American singer and saxophonist (died 2020)
- 1962 — Trevor Goddard, English-American actor (died 2003)
- 1985 — Alanna Nihell, Irish boxer
- 1948 — Marcia Barrett, Jamaican-English singer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1968 — Apollo program: The first live television broadcast by American astronauts in orbit is performed by the Apollo 7 crew.
- 2017 — An Al-Shabaab suicide bomber detonated a massive truck bomb at the Zobe junction in Somalia's capital, Mogadishu, killing 587 people, injuring 316 others, and leaving more than 500 missing.
- 1991 — Burmese opposition leader Aung San Suu Kyi is awarded the Nobel Peace Prize.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1994 — Yasser Arafat, Yitzhak Rabin and Shimon Peres receive the Nobel Peace Prize for their role in the establishment of the Oslo Accords and the framing of future Palestinian self government.
- 1968 — Jim Hines becomes the first man ever to break the so-called "ten-second barrier" in the 100-meter sprint with a time of 9.95 seconds.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1991 — Burmese opposition leader Aung San Suu Kyi is awarded the Nobel Peace Prize.
- 1966 — The city of Montreal begins the operation of its underground Montreal Metro rapid transit system.

- 2004 — MK Airlines Flight 1602 crashes during takeoff from Halifax Stanfield International Airport, killing all seven people on board.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES THU 15 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 288 of the year, 77 days left in 2026. Today Breast Health Day (Europe); Christian feast day: Gundisalvus of Lagos; Christian feast day: Magdalene of Nagasaki; Christian feast day: Teresa of Ávila. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- **1984 — Jessie Ware, English singer-songwriter**
- **1968 — Vanessa Marcil, American actress**
- **1955 — Emma Chichester Clark, English author and illustrator**
- **1999 — Bailee Madison, American-Canadian actress and singer**
- **1957 — Mira Nair, Indian-American actress, director, and producer**
- **1958 — Stephen Clarke, English-French journalist and author**
- **1975 — Chukwudi Iwuji, Nigerian-British actor**
- **1955 — Tanya Roberts, American actress (died 2021)**

THE DAY TOMORROW

- **1979 — A coup d'état in El Salvador overthrows President Carlos Humberto Romero and begins the 12 year-long Salvadoran Civil War.**
- **2006 — The 6.7 Mw Kiholo Bay earthquake rocks Hawaii, causing property damage, injuries, landslides, power outages, and the closure of Honolulu International Airport.**
- **1944 — World War II: Germany replaces the Hungarian government after Hungary announces an armistice with the Soviet Union.**

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- **1951 — Mexican chemist Luis E. Miramontes completes the synthesis of norethisterone, the basis of an early oral contraceptive.**
- **1966 — The Black Panther Party is created by Huey P. Newton and Bobby Seale.**

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10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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